Weekly cetuximab

For selected bowel cancer that has spread, cetuximab aims to control the cancer after previous treatments. For selected locally advanced head-and-neck cancer when platinum chemotherapy is unsuitable, it is combined with radiotherapy. Your team confirms which pathway applies.

Selected metastatic colorectal cancer; or locally advanced head/neck cancer with radiotherapy when platinum is unsuitable · NCCP 00207 v6 · Document revised 5 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

My overall treatment

One larger first infusion is followed by weekly infusions. Bowel-cancer treatment continues while helping and tolerated. For head-and-neck treatment, cetuximab starts one week before radiotherapy and continues until radiation treatment finishes.

A 7-day reference cycle

Cetuximab on Day 1. No home chemotherapy pump. A repeating 7-day cycle. The number of cycles depends on benefit, side effects and your treatment plan. For head-and-neck radiotherapy: start cetuximab one week before radiation, then continue weekly during radiation until it ends.

A typical 7-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–3	Day 4–7
Treatment and checks	Care between visits	Recovery and the next review

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Bloods and suitability** Regimen / treatment suitability	Blood count, kidney/liver tests; confirm cancer setting and RAS result for bowel cancer. Review allergies and symptoms.
During	**Bloods, skin and symptoms** Required by regimen	Blood count, kidney/liver tests regularly as arranged; check skin, eyes, bowel symptoms and hydration.
During / after	**Magnesium and other minerals** Required by regimen	Monitor during treatment; monthly electrolytes, magnesium and calcium for two months after the last antibody dose.
Review	**Response and recovery** Individual plan	Scans and other response tests follow the consultant plan; follow unresolved effects.

Between treatments

- Report painful rash, sore nails, eye pain or worsening breathing promptly. Keep mineral checks after treatment ends.

Bring your medicine list and report new symptoms before dosing. Confirm test appointments, the skin-care plan and urgent contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Eyes

Cetuximab

Eye pain or new visual change needs prompt advice.

2 Blood minerals

Cetuximab

Tests check magnesium and other minerals even when you feel well.

3 Breathing / reaction

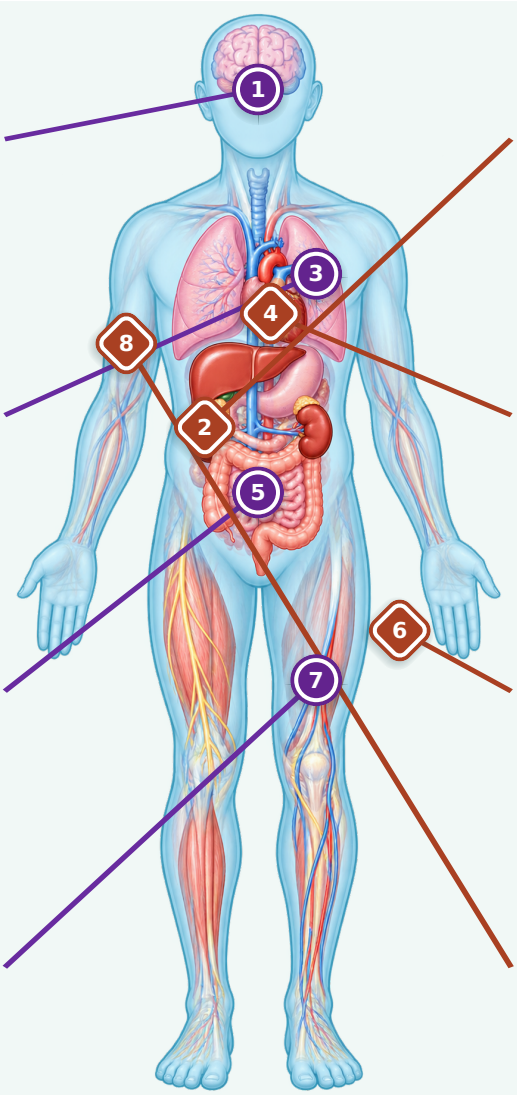
Cetuximab

New breathing difficulty requires prompt assessment.

4 Infusion symptoms

Cetuximab

Tell the nurse immediately about itching, swelling or flushing.



5 Bowel

Treatment

Diarrhoea, increased stoma output or dehydration: call early.

6 Skin / nails

Cetuximab

Report painful rash, cracks or infected skin early.

7 Blood / infection

Treatment

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

8 Infusion access

Treatment delivery

Pain, swelling, leakage or a loose connection needs immediate advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

New breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse, severe diarrhoea or inability to drink require prompt assessment. Report eye pain, blurred vision, blistering or infected skin promptly.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Weekly cetuximab

Cetuximab weekly; radiotherapy dates only if prescribed.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling record; the team confirms the total treatment plan.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.